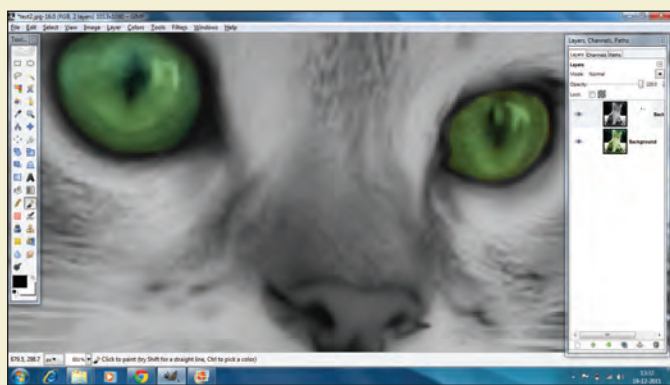




Photograph after using the brush on the layer mask

tings to get the desired result. Doing this manually will take some effort, but the end result makes the effort worth it. You can find more plug-ins and add-ons at goo.gl/uFgOm.

Selective colourisation

If you fancy yourself to be the next Steven Spielberg this technique holds the key. In selective colourisation the photograph is almost entirely converted to black and white, but some parts are left in color for a dramatic effect.



Same image in all its (false) HDR glory

To achieve this, duplicate the image layer, by clicking on the Duplicate button in the Layers window. De-saturate the duplicate layer, by going to **Colors > Desaturate...** and select “Average” for converting that layer to black and white.

In the Layers window, right-click on the B&W layer and select “Add Layer Mask”. In the Add Mask Options dialog, select White (Full Opacity). Now, select the Brush tool, making sure that the foreground colour is black. Select a large brush size and start painting the interior of the parts you want to be coloured. Zoom in when you reach the edge, select a smaller brush with feather for the fringes. Double-check to see if you’ve



An LDR image

left out any part. And Voila! you are done.

Hassle-free HDR images

HDRI stands for High Dynamic Range Imagery, which essentially is a set of techniques allowing a greater dynamic range between the brightest and darkest areas of the image. Normally, such images are computer renderings, or multiple low dynamic range (LDR) images merged into one.

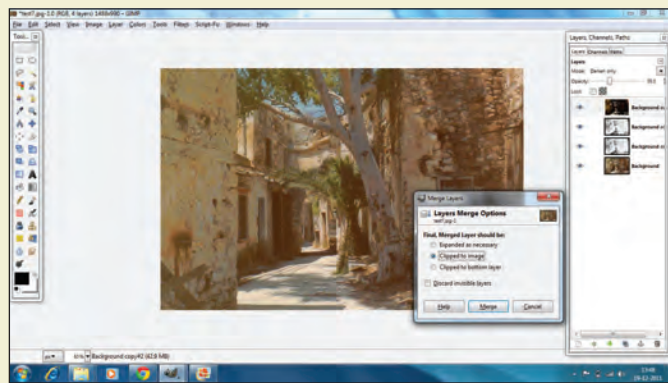
It’s easy to emulate this effect in Gimp, without the headache of merging multiple files followed by tone-mapping. Firstly, install the Dodge and Burn plug-in bundled with this months Alpha DVD. Before you go all

out on converting the image to an HDR one, adjust the brightness and contrast to your liking. In case you’re confused about the best way to do this just run **Colors > Auto > Whitebalance**. In most cases it will even out the brightness and contrast.

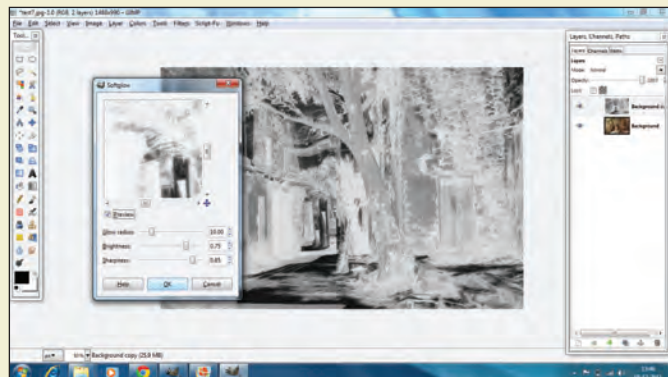
We’ll start off by duplicating the image layer. De-saturate the duplicate layer, by going to **Colors > Desaturate** and

select “Average” in the dialog that appears. Now, with the same layer selected go to **Color > Invert**. Next, apply the soft glow filter by going to **Filters > Artistic > Soft Glow**. Set this layers blend mode to soft light and its opacity to 50 per cent. Now duplicate this layer and set that layers opacity to 75 per cent. Duplicate the original image layer, and bring it on top of

all other layers. Go to **Colors > Levels**, and set the black point in the dialog to 100. The image should now become darker. Change this darker layer’s blend mode to “Dark only” and set this layer’s opacity between 30 to 50 per cent depending on the image. Right-click on the top-most layer and select “Merge Visible Layers”, in the dialog that follows, select “Clipped to image”. Now run the Dodge and Burn plug-in, you’ll find it under **Script-fu > Enhance > Dodge and burn**. In the dialog that follows set Thin to 10 and Thick to 25 (though these values are dependent on the picture, you’ll need to experiment with this tool to get the desired result). Once this is done select the image layer (you’ll get two additional layers called Dodge channel and Burn channel) go to **Colors > Hue-Saturation**, and set the saturation to 50. Next go to **Colors > Levels** and set the black point to 25. That’s it, you just got your faux HDR image. **d**



Merging the layers after performing the first set of operations



Applying the Glowing Edge effect to the newly created layer